

# Xiaohan Zhang

Email: [xiaohan.zhang.research@gmail.com](mailto:xiaohan.zhang.research@gmail.com)

[Homepage](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

## Research Interests

My current research interests lie at the intersection of computer vision and remote sensing (e.g., visual segmentation, detection, and geo-localization in aerial images). I am also interested in image synthesis and 3D reconstruction. Additionally, I am actively working on applying machine learning to computational biology, including generative AI for drug discovery.

## Education

- 2020 – 2026    **University of Vermont** – Burlington, Vermont  
Ph.D. Candidate, Computer Science  
Dissertation: *Finding Structure in Cross-View Geo-Localization: From Geometric Learning to Multi-Modal Reasoning*  
Advisor: Dr. Safwan Wshah
- 2018 – 2020    **University of California, Santa Cruz** – Santa Cruz, California  
M.Sc., Computer Engineering  
Advisor: Dr. Roberto Manduchi
- 2013 – 2017    **Michigan State University** – East Lansing, Michigan  
B.Sc., Computer Engineering

## Employment History

- 2020 – Present    **Graduate Research Assistant**  
Supervised by Dr. Safwan Wshah  
Artificial Intelligence Laboratory (VaiL), University of Vermont.
- 2019 – 2020    **Teaching Assistant**  
CSE 107 Probability and Statistics for Engineers, University of California, Santa Cruz.
- 2017 – 2017    **Undergrad Research Assistant**  
Supervised by Dr. Xiaoming Liu  
Computer Vision Laboratory, Michigan State University

## Honors and Awards

- 2026    IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) Broadening Participation Scholarship Award
- 2025    IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV) Doctoral Consortium Travel Award

- 2025 UAVM'25@ACM Multimedia Outstanding Reviewer (ACM MM 2025, 3rd Workshop on UAVs in Multimedia)
- 2025 IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) Outstanding Reviewers
- 2024 UAVM'24@ACM Multimedia Outstanding Reviewer (ACM MM 2024, 2nd Workshop on UAVs in Multimedia)
- 2023 Computer Science Graduate Award (The University of Vermont College of Engineering and Mathematical Sciences)
- 2023 AAAI Student Scholarship (Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence)
- 2022 Second Prize in UVM Computing Student Research Day (UVM CSRSD '22)

## Publications

### Journal Articles

1. Muhammad Adil, Patrick J. Clemins, Andrew W. Schroth, Panagiotis D. Oikonomou, Donna M. Rizzo, Peter D. F. Isles, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Kareem I. Hannoun, Scott Turnbull, Noah B. Beckage, Asim Zia, and Safwan Wshah. "From Remote Sensing to Multiple Time Horizons Forecasts: Transformers Model for CyanoHAB Intensity in Lake Champlain." IEEE Journal of Selected Topics in Applied Earth Observations and Remote Sensing (2026).
2. **Xiaohan Zhang**, Xingyu Li, Waqas Sultani, Chen Chen, and Safwan Wshah. "GeoDTR+: Toward generic cross-view geolocalization via geometric disentanglement." IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (2024).
3. Daniel Wilson, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Waqas Sultani, and Safwan Wshah. "Image and object geo-localization." International Journal of Computer Vision (2024).
4. Nathaniel Ogilvie, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Cale Kochenour, and Safwan Wshah. "Fine-Grained Permeable Surface Mapping through Parallel U-Net." Sensors (2024).
5. Daniel Wilson, Thayer Alshaabi, Colin Van Oort, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Jonathan Nelson, and Safwan Wshah. "Object tracking and geo-localization from street images." Remote Sensing (2022).

### Conference Papers

1. Ahmad Arrabi, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Waqas Sultani, Chen Chen, and Safwan Wshah. "Cross-view meets diffusion: Aerial image synthesis with geometry and text guidance." In IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV), 2025.
2. **Xiaohan Zhang**, Xingyu Li, Waqas Sultani, Yi Zhou, and Safwan Wshah. "Cross-view geo-localization via learning disentangled geometric layout correspondence." In Proceedings of the AAAI conference on artificial intelligence, 2023.
3. **Xiaohan Zhang**, Waqas Sultani, and Safwan Wshah. "Cross-view image sequence geo-localization." In Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision, pp. 2914-2923. 2023.
4. **Xiaohan Zhang**, and Safwan Wshah. "LanePainter: lane marks enhancement via generative adversarial network." In the International Conference on Pattern Recognition (ICPR), 2022.

5. Minghao Liu, Jiahao Luo, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Yang Liu, and James Davis. "Low-light image enhancement using chain-consistent adversarial networks." In the International Conference on Pattern Recognition (ICPR), 2022.

### Workshops & Preprints

1. Ayesha Abu Lehyeh, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Ahmad Arrabi, Waqas Sultani, Chen Chen, and Safwan Wshah. "GeoFlow: Real-Time Fine-Grained Cross-View Geolocalization via Iterative Flow Prediction." arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.21943 (2026).
2. Yancheng Zhang, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Guangyu Sun, Zonglin Lyu, Safwan Wshah, and Chen Chen. "Geo<sup>2</sup>: Geometry-Guided Cross-view Geo-Localization and Image Synthesis." arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.25819 (2026).
3. Yuqi Chen, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Ahmad Arrabi, Waqas Sultani, Chen Chen, and Safwan Wshah. "Turning Generators into Retrievers: Unlocking MLLMs for Natural Language-Guided Geo-Localization." arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.10721 (2026).
4. **Xiaohan Zhang**, Tavis Shore, Chen Chen, Oscar Mendez, Simon Hadfield, and Safwan Wshah. "VICI: VLM-Instructed Cross-view Image-localisation." In Proceedings of the 3rd International Workshop on UAVs in Multimedia: Capturing the World from a New Perspective, 2025.
5. Daniel Wilson, **Xiaohan Zhang**, Waqas Sultani, and Safwan Wshah. "Visual and object geo-localization: A comprehensive survey." arXiv preprint arXiv:2112.15202.

### Teaching & Mentorship Experience

#### Teaching – CSE 107 Probability and Statistics for Engineer

- Facilitated weekly discussion sections for 30+ undergraduate students, reinforcing core concepts in probability theory and statistical reasoning.
- Held weekly office hours to support problem-solving, conceptual understanding, and exam preparation.
- Graded exams and assignments and provided detailed feedback aligned with course learning objectives.

#### Mentoring – Vermont Artificial Intelligence Laboratory (VaiL)

- Mentored Ahmad Arrabi (Ph.D. student) on generative AI for aerial imagery synthesis, resulting in a co-authored publication at WACV 2025.
- Mentored Muhammad Adil (Ph.D. student) on remote sensing forecasting models, leading to a journal article in the IEEE J-STARS.
- Supervised Nathaniel Ogilvie (M.S. student) on fine-grained permeable surface mapping, resulting in a publication in Sensors.
- Currently mentoring several junior Ph.D. students on visual geo-localization and generative AI for biological applications; multiple manuscripts under review.

### Grant Writing Experience

I assisted in several proposal preparations.

- National Science Foundation (NSF): Contributed to the research statement and data collection plan for a proposal on robust geo-localization. (Status: Under Review)

- Intelligence Advanced Research Projects Activity (IARPA): Contributed to the technical approach and broader impact for IARPA BAA. (Status: Under Review)

## Academic Service

### Workshop / Tutorial / Competition Organizer

Chen Chen, Safwan Wshah, **Xiaohan Zhang**, “Cross-View Geo-Localization: Current Challenges and Future Frontiers”, WACV 2025 Tutorial, [Website](#)

Chen Chen, Safwan Wshah, **Xiaohan Zhang**, “Beyond Vision: Multimodal Perspectives for Cross-View Geo-Localization”, WACV 2026 Tutorial, [Website](#)

### Conference Service

Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition, Reviewer, 2024, 2025, 2026

European Conference on Computer Vision, Reviewer, 2024, 2026

AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Program Committee, 2025, 2026

European Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Program Committee, 2025

ACM Multimedia Systems Conference, Reviewer, 2024, 2025

### Selected Journal Reviewer

IEEE Transactions on Neural Networks and Learning Systems

ISPRS Journal of Photogrammetry and Remote Sensing

IEEE Transactions on Geoscience and Remote Sensing

IEEE Transactions on Circuits and Systems for Video Technology

IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters

MDPI Remote Sensing

npj Drug Discovery

npj Heritage Science